SSC GD Constable 2022 question paper with answers

6 February 2023 · Shift 4

71 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 9 of the paper's 80 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20230219070003/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Write_up_Constable_GD_2022_18022023.pdf

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning 16 questions

Q.2

If A denotes +, B denotes –, and C denotes ×, then what will be the value of the following equation? 20 C 5 A 3 C 2 B 16

(A) 80
(B) 100
(C) 90
(D) 85

Q.3

Six friends Sarthi, Pari, Vani, Kabir, Arshi, and Kamal,are sitting in a circle. All of them are facing the centre.Sarthi sits second to the left of Pari. Vani sits third to the right of Kabir. Arshi is an immediate neighbour of Pari and Kabir. Who sits fourth to the left of Vani?

(A) Pari
(B) Kabir
(C) Arshi
(D) Kamal

Q.7

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? FSCW, HQEU, JOGS, LMIQ, ?

(A) NKLO
(B) MLJP
(C) MNKO
(D) NKKO

Q.8

O,P,Q,R and S are sitting on a circular table facing towards the centre. R is sitting to the immediate left of S. Q is sitting to the immediate right of O. S is the immediate neighbour of R and O. P is sitting to the immediate left of R. Who is sitting to the immediate right of Q?

(A) O
(B) P
(C) R
(D) S

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. REALITY : YEALITR :: SCIENCE : ECIENCS :: ADVERSE : ?

(A) VERSEAD
(B) EDVERSA
(C) VDAERSE
(D) ESREVDA

Q.10

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 96, 48, 60, 30, 42, 21, ?

(A) 30
(B) 37
(C) 33
(D) 32

Q.11

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 12, 23, 45, 56, 78, 89, 111, 122, ?

(A) 322
(B) 144
(C) 43
(D) 133

Q.12

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. GLOW: SOMF :: LIKE: NRQX :: SAVE: ?

(A) UCTX
(B) GZFX
(C) GYEW
(D) HZEW

Q.13

In a certain code language, STAR is coded as 58, and ALARM is coded as 45. How will STAGE be coded in the same language?

(A) 51
(B) 50
(C) 49
(D) 52

Q.14

A @ B means 'A is the sister of B'. A & B means 'A is the brother of B'. A # B means 'A is the wife of B'. A ^ B means 'A is the mother of B'. A + B means 'A is the father of B'. If A & C + E ^ G # I & K + M @ O, then which of the following statements is NOT correct?

(A) K is the father of O.
(B) I is the son of E.
(C) M is the daughter of K.
(D) C is the maternal grandfather of G.

Q.15

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? ADLU, EGOO, ? , OMUE, UPXA

(A) ILIR
(B) JIIR
(C) IJRI
(D) IKRI

Q.16

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /subtracting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed) (9, 14, 161); (12, 18, 210)

(A) (23, 40, 371)
(B) (40, 20, 340)
(C) (11, 33, 348)
(D) (29, 17, 322)

Q.17

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1. TOPOLOGY 2. TOPIC 3. TOPAZ 4. TOUR 5. TORTILLA 6. TORN

(A) 2, 3, 1, 6, 5, 4
(B) 1, 3, 2, 6, 5, 4
(C) 1, 2, 3, 6, 5, 4
(D) 3, 2, 1, 6, 5, 4

Q.18

In this question, three statements are given, followed by two conclusions numbered I and II. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follows/follow from the statements. Statements: All bangles are coins. All coins are anklets. All anklets are lockets. Conclusions: I. All lockets are bangles. II. Some lockets are coins.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Only conclusion II follows.

Q.19

Which two signs should be interchanged to make the below equation mathematically correct? 104 ÷ 13 + 60 - 5 × 2 = 115

(A) ÷ and ×
(B) ÷ and -
(C) + and ×
(D) × and -

Q.20

In a certain code language, ‘ENTITY’ is written as ‘UOFAVK’ and 'EQUITY' is written as 'VRFAVK'. How will ‘ESCAPE’ be written as in that language?

(A) CSEEPA
(B) DTFEPA
(C) DTFGRC
(D) EPACSE

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness 20 questions

Q.1

What was the targeted economic growth rate as per the Sixth Five year plan?

(A) 5.8
(B) 6.3
(C) 5.2
(D) 6.0

Q.2

What is the minimum age of a candidate to become the president of India?

(A) 25
(B) 20
(C) 35
(D) 30

Q.3

Public debt is burdensome if it _____ future growth in output.

(A) reduces
(B) magnifies
(C) increases
(D) expands

Q.4

Who became the youngest speaker in the history of the Maharashtra State Assembly in July 2022?

(A) Sajan Shah
(B) Sandeep Maheshwari
(C) Rahul Narwekar
(D) Vivek Bindra

Q.5

In which of the following climates you cannot grow a rubber crop?

(A) tropical climate
(B) sub-tropical climate
(C) equatorial climate
(D) polar climate

Q.6

Who became the Member of Legislative Assembly from Andheri East constituency in Maharashtra, India in November 2022?

(A) Devendra Fadnavis
(B) Rutuja Latke
(C) Narayan Rane
(D) Chandrakant Jadhav

Q.7

Which is the second most populated state of India as per the Census 2011?

(A) Bihar
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Maharashtra

Q.8

Given among the following,_____is a food crop

(A) jute
(B) cotton
(C) rice
(D) rubber

Q.9

The Resolution of Non-Cooperation movement was confirmed in the annual session of the Indian National Congress at _____ in December 1920.

(A) Madras
(B) Nagpur
(C) Bhopal
(D) Surat

Q.10

Which of the following dancer won a Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 2004?

(A) Krishna Ella
(B) Anuradha Pandey
(C) Jatin Goswami
(D) Amala Akkineni

Q.11

The Sattriya dance, one of the classical dances of India depicts the teachings of which of the following religions?

(A) Hinduism
(B) Sikhism
(C) Jainism
(D) Buddhism

Q.12

Karaga, one of the oldest festivals of _____, is celebrated in honour of Goddess Shakti.

(A) Karnataka
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Kerala
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.13

What obstructs the South-West monsoon winds which come from the Arabian Sea while flowing towards the Intertropical Convergence Zone?

(A) Great Himalayan range
(B) Western Ghats
(C) Aravalli Range
(D) Eastern Ghats

Q.14

Which is the largest Democracy in the world?

(A) India
(B) USA
(C) Brazil
(D) China

Q.15

The Satavahana kingdom was established about how many years ago?

(A) 2400
(B) 2100
(C) 1700
(D) 2800

Q.16

The 35th National Games of India were held in which year?

(A) 2014
(B) 2015
(C) 2017
(D) 2013

Q.17

Saikhom Mirabai Chanu is an _____.

(A) Indian Boxer
(B) Indian weightlifter
(C) Indian Wrestler
(D) Indian cyclist

Q.18

Chemical formula for the marble is _____.

(A) CaO
(B) $Ca(OH)_2$
(C) $CaCO_3$
(D) CO2

Q.19

_____is the fluid content inside the plasma membrane.

(A) mitochondria
(B) nucleus
(C) chromatin
(D) cytoplasm

Q.20

_____intends to provide skill development and placement oriented training across the entire textile value chain, excluding Spinning and Weaving in the organized sector.

(A) Merchandise Export From India Scheme
(B) Sewa Scheme
(C) MPLADS (Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme)
(D) Samarth Scheme

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics 15 questions

Q.1

In a certain rectangle, the ratio of length to width of the rectangle is 3 : 2 and the area is 150 cm^2. The perimeter of the rectangle is:

(A) 25 cm
(B) 50 cm
(C) 100 cm
(D) 30 cm

Q.4

If A is the average of first 5 natural numbers and B is the average of first 5 natural numbers which are perfect squares, then what is the average of A and B?

(A) 8
(B) 10
(C) 7
(D) 9

Q.6

20 men can finish a piece of work in 5 days, whereas it takes 24 women to finish it in 5 days. If 30 men and 12 women undertake to complete the work, how many days will they take to complete it?

(A) 3
(B) 1.5
(C) 5
(D) 2.5

Q.7

The diameter and height of a cylindrical tower are 10 m and 21m, respectively. What will be the cost of painting its curved surface, at the rate of Rs.8 per m^2? (Use $\pi = 22/7$)

(A) Rs.4,980
(B) Rs.5,280
(C) Rs.5,490
(D) Rs.5,130

Q.8

The Rajdhani train travels in a straight line at a constant speed of 75 km/h for a particular distance ‘d’ and then travels another distance equal to ‘2d’ at a constant speed of 100 km/h in the same direction as earlier. Find the average speed of the train during the whole journey?

(A) 84 km/h
(B) 90 km/h
(C) 96 km/h
(D) 88 km/h

Q.9

In a school, the ratio of boys to girls is 7 : 11. If there are 3420 students in the school, then how many girls are there in the school? (There are only boys and girls in the school.)

(A) 1330
(B) 2090
(C) 902
(D) 760

Q.11

Applied to a bill for Rs. 10000 the difference between a discount of 30 percent and two successive discounts of 22 percent and 8 percent is:

(A) Rs. 138
(B) Rs. 144
(C) Rs. 176
(D) Rs. 124

Q.13

The greatest number, by which when the numbers 1658 and 2038 are divided, the remainders are 7 and 6, respectively, is:

(A) 112
(B) 127
(C) 117
(D) 137

Q.14

A trader mixes 26 kg of raw salt which costs Rs.2 per kg with 30 kg of raw salt which costs Rs.3.60 per kg. If he sells the mixture for Rs.3 per kg, find his gain%.

(A) 8%
(B) 3%
(C) 10%
(D) 5%

Q.15

A, B, and C can complete a work in 4 days, 8 days, and 16 days respectively. If all three work on alternate days such that A works on first day, B works on second day, C works on third day and A works on fourth day and so on, then find the number of days in which 175% of the work is done.

(A) 12 days
(B) 5 days
(C) 9 days
(D) 11 days

Q.16

Two successive price increases of 5% and 5% of an article are equivalent to a single price increase of:

(A) 10.25%
(B) 10.50%
(C) 10.00%
(D) 9.75%

Q.17

In which ratio a trader must mix two quantities of ₹18 per kg and ₹27 per kg, so that the price of the mixture becomes ₹25 per kg?

(A) 1 : 7
(B) 3 : 7
(C) 2 : 7
(D) 2 : 5

Q.18

A man purchased 25 litres of milk at the cost price of Rs.25 per litre. Now he added 5 litres of water to it and sold the mixture at the cost price. Find the profit percentage for the man.

(A) 10%
(B) 20%
(C) 25%
(D) 15%

Q.19

A discount of 20% on one article is the same as a discount of 25% on another article. The marked price of article can be?

(A) ₹100 and ₹120
(B) ₹100 and ₹60
(C) ₹100 and ₹80
(D) ₹100 and ₹40

Q.20

Which number is one less than the sum of all the prime factors of 2310?

(A) 33
(B) 29
(C) 27
(D) 25

Part-D-English 20 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "Nalini was not satisfy with her birthday dress", but she wore it anyway.

(A) Nalini was not satisfied for her birthday dress
(B) No substitution required
(C) Nalini was not satisfied with her birthday dress
(D) Nalini were not satisfied by her birthday dress

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Abolish

(A) Construct
(B) Reverberate
(C) Eradicate
(D) Pontificate

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Experiences lead you towards the most fascinating "stage of your living" that you will cherish forever.

(A) feature of your work
(B) set of your routine
(C) part of your life
(D) glory of your day

Q.4

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Sam shall went to / the office tomorrow to / get back his original documents / lying with the staff.

(A) get back his original documents
(B) Sam shall went to
(C) the office tomorrow to
(D) lying with the staff

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. White elephant

(A) A business company in bankruptcy
(B) Something that costs a lot of money but has no useful purpose
(C) Something very rare and precious
(D) A big lie that is concealed from all

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word to fill in the blank in the sentence. Deceive; My mother said, “Don’t _____ yourself, Adi. Pay attention to your studies.”

(A) shine
(B) handle
(C) trick
(D) believe

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Worthless

(A) Insult
(B) Productive
(C) Kind
(D) Ineffective

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The captain “feels very proudly” as his team has won the match.

(A) feel very proudly
(B) feels most pride
(C) feels much proud
(D) feels very proud

Q.9

Select the most appropriate homophone to fill in the blank. There was a big hole in the wall which they are trying to close. It took a _____ day for them to do the job.

(A) while
(B) whale
(C) hold
(D) whole

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. The novelist depicted the moral “decay” of the society through his novels.

(A) Conviction
(B) Degeneration
(C) Integrity
(D) Indignation

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Culpable

(A) Absolved
(B) Vindicated
(C) Guilty
(D) Acquitted

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Mandatory

(A) Imperative
(B) Requisite
(C) Unavoidable
(D) Optional

Q.13

Identify the correctly spelt sentence.

(A) Scientists are looking for alternative energy to save non-renewable resources.
(B) Scientists are looking for alternative energy to save non-reneable resources.
(C) Scientists are looking for allternative energy to save non-renewable resources.
(D) Scientists are looking for alternetive energy to save non-renewable resources.

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Like oil and water

(A) Two people who like each other
(B) Two people who are different from each other
(C) Two people who are similar to each other
(D) Two people who like to work with each other

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Constipation
(B) Hallucination
(C) Reverberation
(D) Ockupation

Q.16

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Amidst all the chaos and suffering caused by the pandemic, there are some positive stories of grit, (1)_____ and bravado. Some businesses understood the needs of the times to make (2)_____profits. Businesses diversified and (3)_____successful. Although there are numerous stories of people and business owners (4)_____ due to lockdowns, this small percentage of success stories is like the light at the end of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) persistence
(B) perspiration
(C) silence
(D) laxity

Q.17

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Amidst all the chaos and suffering caused by the pandemic, there are some positive stories of grit, (1)_____ and bravado. Some businesses understood the needs of the times to make (2)_____profits. Businesses diversified and (3)_____successful. Although there are numerous stories of people and business owners (4)_____ due to lockdowns, this small percentage of success stories is like the light at the end of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) elite
(B) slow
(C) tiny
(D) huge

Q.18

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Amidst all the chaos and suffering caused by the pandemic, there are some positive stories of grit, (1)_____ and bravado. Some businesses understood the needs of the times to make (2)_____profits. Businesses diversified and (3)_____successful. Although there are numerous stories of people and business owners (4)_____ due to lockdowns, this small percentage of success stories is like the light at the end of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) were
(B) are
(C) can
(D) aren't

Q.19

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Amidst all the chaos and suffering caused by the pandemic, there are some positive stories of grit, (1)_____ and bravado. Some businesses understood the needs of the times to make (2)_____profits. Businesses diversified and (3)_____successful. Although there are numerous stories of people and business owners (4)_____ due to lockdowns, this small percentage of success stories is like the light at the end of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) relishing
(B) pushing
(C) emptying
(D) suffering

Q.20

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Amidst all the chaos and suffering caused by the pandemic, there are some positive stories of grit, (1)_____ and bravado. Some businesses understood the needs of the times to make (2)_____profits. Businesses diversified and (3)_____successful. Although there are numerous stories of people and business owners (4)_____ due to lockdowns, this small percentage of success stories is like the light at the end of the (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) kernel

(B) hill

(C) rope

(D) tunnel

Answer key

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**
Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**		

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**				

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**
Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**			

Part-D-English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**				

Explanations

Part-A-General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.2 · Answer (C) 90

With A = +, B = − and C = ×: 20 × 5 + 3 × 2 − 16 = 100 + 6 − 16 = 90.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Arshi

Facing the centre, each person's left runs clockwise. Arshi sits between Pari and Kabir, and Vani, third to the right of Kabir, sits opposite him; Sarthi, second to the left of Pari, then fits only if the clockwise order is Kabir, Arshi, Pari, Vani, Sarthi, Kamal. Counting four to the left of Vani: Sarthi, Kamal, Kabir, Arshi.

Q.7 · Answer (D) NKKO

In each cluster the first and third letters move 2 forward and the second and fourth 2 back: F, H, J, L, N; S, Q, O, M, K; C, E, G, I, K; W, U, S, Q, O. The next term is NKKO.

Q.8 · Answer (B) P

Facing the centre, each person's left runs clockwise. Clockwise the order is S, R, P, Q, O: R is to S's left, P to R's left, S between R and O, and Q to O's right. The person to Q's immediate right is P.

Q.9 · Answer (B) EDVERSA

The first and last letters change places: REALITY → YEALITR and SCIENCE → ECIENCS. So ADVERSE → EDVERSA.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 33

The terms are halved and increased by 12 in turn: 96 ÷ 2 = 48, 48 + 12 = 60, 60 ÷ 2 = 30, 30 + 12 = 42, 42 ÷ 2 = 21, and 21 + 12 = 33.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 144

The differences alternate +11 and +22: 12, 23, 45, 56, 78, 89, 111, 122, and then 122 + 22 = 144.

Q.12 · Answer (B) GZFX

Each letter is replaced by its opposite (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on) and the four letters are then moved −1, 0, +1 and +2: GLOW → TOLD → SOMF and LIKE → ORPV → NRQX. So SAVE → HZEV → GZFX.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 52

Each word is coded as the sum of its letters' places in the alphabet: STAR = 19 + 20 + 1 + 18 = 58 and ALARM = 1 + 12 + 1 + 18 + 13 = 45. So STAGE = 19 + 20 + 1 + 7 + 5 = 52.

Q.14 · Answer (B) I is the son of E.

A is C's brother, C is E's father, E is G's mother, G is I's wife, I is K's brother, K is M's father and M is O's sister. E is I's mother-in-law, not his mother, so 'I is the son of E' is not correct; K is O's father, M is K's daughter and C, E's father, is G's maternal grandfather.

Q.15 · Answer (C) IJRI

The first letters are the vowels A, E, I, O, U in order and the fourth letters the same vowels backwards; the second letters move 3 forward (D, G, J, M, P) and so do the third (L, O, R, U, X). The missing term is IJRI.

Q.16 · Answer (D) (29, 17, 322)

The third number is 7 times the sum of the other two: (9 + 14) × 7 = 161 and (12 + 18) × 7 = 210. Likewise (29 + 17) × 7 = 322; the other sets would need 441, 420 and 308.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 3, 2, 1, 6, 5, 4

In dictionary order: topaz (3), topic (2), topology (1), torn (6), tortilla (5), tour (4). 'Topa' comes before 'topi' and 'topo', 'top' before 'tor' and 'tou', and 'torn' before 'tort'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Only conclusion II follows.

Bangles lie inside coins, coins inside anklets and anklets inside lockets, so all coins are lockets and some lockets are coins (II). Lockets need not all be bangles, so I does not follow.

Q.19 · Answer (B) ÷ and -
After interchanging ÷ and –: 104 – 13 + 60 ÷ 5 × 2 = 104 – 13 + 24 = 115.

Q.20 · Answer (C) DTFGRC
Each half of the word is reversed, and then the letters of the first half move 1 forward and those of the second half 2 forward: ENT ITY → TNE YTI → UOF AVK and EQU ITY → UQE YTI → VRF AVK. So ESC APE → CSE EPA → DTF GRC: DTFGRC.

Part-B-General Knowledge and General awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) 5.2
The Sixth Five Year Plan (1980-85) aimed at a growth rate of 5.2% a year in gross national product.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 35
Under Article 58 a candidate for President must be a citizen of India, have completed 35 years of age and be qualified for election to the Lok Sabha.

Q.3 · Answer (A) reduces
Interest and repayment come out of future taxes, which cut people's disposable income, and government borrowing draws on savings that could have gone into private investment. To the extent that this lowers capital formation and so future growth in output, the debt is a burden on future generations.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Rahul Narwekar
SSC's key gives Rahul Narwekar of the BJP, elected Speaker of the Maharashtra Legislative Assembly on 3 July 2022. Some reports then called him the youngest to hold the post; others call him the second-youngest, after Shivraj Patil, who was elected to it at 42. Either way he is the only option who became Speaker in July 2022.

Q.5 · Answer (D) polar climate
Rubber grows best in hot, wet equatorial lands and, where conditions allow, in tropical and sub-tropical areas too; it needs heavy rain and high temperatures, which polar regions lack.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Rutuja Latke
Rutuja Latke of the Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray) won the Andheri East by-election of 3 November 2022, held after the death of her husband, the sitting MLA Ramesh Latke; the result was declared on 6 November.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Maharashtra
By the 2011 Census Maharashtra, with about 11.2 crore people, is the second most populous state after Uttar Pradesh (about 20 crore); Bihar is third.

Q.8 · Answer (C) rice
Rice is a food crop, grown to be eaten. Jute and cotton are fibre crops, and rubber is a plantation crop grown for its latex.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Nagpur
A special session at Calcutta in September 1920 adopted the Non-Cooperation programme, and the annual session at Nagpur in December 1920 confirmed it.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Jatin Goswami
Jatin Goswami, a Sattriya dancer and guru from Assam, received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Sattriya dance in 2004.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Hinduism
Sattriya, created by the saint Srimanta Sankardeva in Assam and kept alive in the Vaishnava monasteries called sattras, presents the teachings of Vaishnavism, a tradition of Hinduism.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Karnataka
The Bengaluru Karaga, held at the Dharmaraya Swamy temple at the Chaitra full moon, is one of the city's oldest festivals; the Thigala community celebrates it in honour of Draupadi, worshipped as a form of Shakti.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Western Ghats
The Arabian Sea branch of the south-west monsoon strikes the Western Ghats, which force the winds to rise and bring heavy rain to their windward, western slopes.

Q.14 · Answer (A) India
India, which has the largest electorate of any country, is the world's largest democracy. China is a one-party state, and the USA and Brazil have far fewer voters.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 2100
SSC's key gives 2100, following the school account in which the Satavahanas became powerful in western India about 200 years after the Cholas, Cheras and Pandyas rose in the south around 2300 years ago. Historians date the dynasty's beginnings anywhere from the third to the first century BCE.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 2015
The 35th National Games were held in Kerala from 31 January to 14 February 2015.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Indian weightlifter
Saikhom Mirabai Chanu of Manipur is a weightlifter; she won silver in the women's 49 kg at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics.

Q.18 · Answer (C) $CaCO_3$
Marble is metamorphosed limestone, made of calcium carbonate, $CaCO_3$. CaO is quicklime, $Ca(OH)_2$ slaked lime and CO_2 carbon dioxide.

Q.19 · Answer (D) cytoplasm
The cytoplasm is the fluid within the plasma membrane in which the cell's organelles lie; mitochondria are organelles, and chromatin lies within the nucleus.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Samarth Scheme
Samarth, the Ministry of Textiles' Scheme for Capacity Building in Textile Sector approved in 2017, offers demand-driven, placement-oriented skilling across the textile value chain except spinning and weaving in the organised sector.

Part-C-Elementary Mathematics

Q.1 · Answer (B) 50 cm
With length 3k and width 2k, $6k^2 = 150$, so k = 5: the sides are 15 cm and 10 cm and the perimeter is $2 \times (15 + 10) = 50$ cm.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 7
A = (1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5) ÷ 5 = 3 and B = (1 + 4 + 9 + 16 + 25) ÷ 5 = 11, so their average is (3 + 11) ÷ 2 = 7.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 2.5
The work is 20 × 5 = 100 man-days or 24 × 5 = 120 woman-days, so a man does 1/100 and a woman 1/120 of it a day. Together 30/100 + 12/120 = 0.3 + 0.1 = 0.4 of the work a day, so 1 ÷ 0.4 = 2.5 days.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Rs.5,280
Curved surface = $2\pi rh = 2 \times 22/7 \times 5 \times 21 = 660$ m², so the cost is 660 × 8 = ₹5,280.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 90 km/h
Average speed = total distance ÷ total time = 3d ÷ (d/75 + 2d/100) = 3 ÷ (1/75 + 1/50) = 3 ÷ (5/150) = 90 km/h.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 2090
Girls are 11 of every 18 students: 3420 × 11/18 = 190 × 11 = 2090.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Rs. 176
A single 30% discount leaves ₹7,000. Discounts of 22% and 8% leave 10,000 × 0.78 × 0.92 = ₹7,176. The difference is ₹176.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 127
The number must divide 1658 – 7 = 1651 and 2038 – 6 = 2032 exactly, so it is their HCF: 1651 = 127 × 13 and 2032 = 127 × 16, and 13 and 16 have no common factor, so the HCF is 127.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 5%
Cost = 26 × 2 + 30 × 3.60 = 52 + 108 = ₹160. The 56 kg sell for 56 × 3 = ₹168, a gain of ₹8: 8/160 × 100 = 5%.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 12 days
A does 1/4, B 1/8 and C 1/16 of the work a day, so each 3-day round does 4/16 + 2/16 + 1/16 = 7/16. 175% of the work is 7/4 = 28/16, exactly four rounds: 12 days.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 10.25%
1.05 × 1.05 = 1.1025, an increase of 10.25% (5 + 5 + 5 × 5/100).

Q.17 · Answer (C) 2 : 7
By alligation, the ₹18 and ₹27 kinds are mixed in the ratio (27 – 25) : (25 – 18) = 2 : 7.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 20%
He pays 25 × 25 = ₹625 and sells 30 litres at ₹25: ₹750. Profit = 125/625 × 100 = 20%.

Q.19 · Answer (C) ₹100 and ₹80
20% of the first marked price equals 25% of the second, so the prices are in the ratio 25 : 20 = 5 : 4. Of the options only ₹100 and ₹80 are in that ratio: 20% of 100 = 25% of 80 = 20.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 27
2310 = 2 × 3 × 5 × 7 × 11, and 2 + 3 + 5 + 7 + 11 = 28; one less is 27.

Part-D-English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Nalini was not satisfied with her birthday dress
After 'was' the verb must be the past participle 'satisfied', and one is satisfied 'with' something: 'Nalini was not satisfied with her birthday dress'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Construct
To 'abolish' is to put an end to a law, system or practice; its exact opposite, 'establish', is not offered, and 'construct', to build or set up, comes nearest. 'Eradicate' is close to 'abolish' in meaning, and 'reverberate' (echo) and 'pontificate' (speak pompously) are unrelated.

Q.3 · Answer (C) part of your life
'Stage of your living' is not idiomatic; 'part of your life' is the natural phrase for something one will cherish forever.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Sam shall went to
A modal such as 'shall' takes the base form of the verb: 'Sam shall go to', not 'shall went'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Something that costs a lot of money but has no useful purpose
A 'white elephant' is a possession that costs a great deal to keep but is of no real use.

Q.6 · Answer (C) trick
To 'deceive' is to trick or mislead: 'Don't trick yourself' means don't fool yourself.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Productive
'Worthless' means having no value or use; its exact opposites ('valuable', 'useful') are not offered, and 'productive', yielding useful results, comes nearest. 'Ineffective' is close to 'worthless', and 'insult' and 'kind' are unrelated.

Q.8 · Answer (D) feels very proud
'Feel' is a linking verb, so it takes an adjective, not an adverb, and 'feels' agrees with the singular subject: 'The captain feels very proud'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) whole
'Whole', meaning entire, sounds like 'hole' but differs in spelling and meaning: 'It took a whole day'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Degeneration
Moral 'decay' is a decline in standards: 'degeneration'. 'Integrity' is nearly its opposite, and 'conviction' and 'indignation' do not fit.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Guilty
'Culpable' means deserving blame: 'guilty'. 'Absolved', 'vindicated' and 'acquitted' all mean cleared of blame.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Optional
'Mandatory' means required by rule; its opposite is 'optional'. 'Imperative', 'requisite' and 'unavoidable' are close to it in meaning.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Scientists are looking for alternative energy to save non-renewable resources.
The words are spelt 'alternative' and 'non-renewable'; the other sentences have 'non-reneable', 'allternative' and 'alternetive'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Two people who are different from each other
People who are 'like oil and water' are so different that they do not mix or get along.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Ockupation
'Ockupation' is misspelt: the word is 'occupation', with 'cc'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) persistence
The positive stories are of grit, 'persistence' (keeping on despite difficulty) and bravado, qualities that go together.

Q.17 · Answer (D) huge
Businesses that understood the needs of the times made 'huge' profits, in keeping with the success stories.

Q.18 · Answer (A) were
The passage is in the past tense ('understood', 'diversified'), so the businesses 'were' successful.

Q.19 · Answer (D) suffering
Set against the few success stories are the many of people and businesses 'suffering' due to lockdowns.

Q.20 · Answer (D) tunnel
'The light at the end of the tunnel' is the idiom for a sign of hope after a hard time.

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